Reference Document Utility Report

What Each Source Contains and How It Supports the Project

Skill Development & Career Readiness for FYE Student Employees

Prepared for: FYE Research & Engagement Project
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Abstract

This report inventories the research reference documents used for the FYE study and explains, for each source: (1) what it contains, (2) how it can be used in the FYE study, and (3) how it connects to the project's goals. Project-management files (such as the REC proposal template and internal utility summary) are excluded here; they are used only for planning and updates, not as research evidence. The project assesses skill development and career readiness practices built into FYE student employment—weekly competency reflection, assessment and feedback, guided professional goal-setting, and interview support—across new employees, returning employees, and past employees in post-graduate careers. Together, the research references provide local practice benchmarks, assessment templates, career-education tools, and external employer/future-skills evidence needed to design, justify, and improve the study.

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1 Project Connection (What This Report Must Support)

The FYE Research & Engagement project seeks to understand and strengthen how student employment builds career readiness. Specifically, the study focuses on:

1. Weekly competency reflection;
2. Assessment and feedback (self-report + supervisor/lead feedback);
3. Guided professional goal-setting;
4. Interview support;
5. Multi-cohort impact (new, returning, and alumni/post-graduate employees);
6. Program improvement recommendations for FYE.

The research references fall into two groups:

- **Local / campus practice documents** that describe how student employment and evaluation currently work;
- **External frameworks and labor-market evidence** that define which skills matter for career readiness now and through 2030.

Files used only for project updating (REC proposal template; internal markdown utility summary) are not treated as research references in this report.

2 Document Inventory at a Glance

Document	Type	Primary role for this project
Master Student Employment Agreement.docx	Campus employment norms	Benchmark for professionalism, check-ins, and developmental framing
Student Assistant Evaluation Sheet.xlsx	Evaluation instrument	Template for rubrics, mid/end assessment, reflective prompts
career-handbook-2.pdf	Career education toolkit	NACE competencies, skill statements, STAR interview tools
2026-job-outlook-report-spring-update.pdf	NACE employer survey	Current hiring/skills demand; skills-with-examples finding
WEF_Future_of_Jobs_Report_2025.pdf	Global skills outlook	Future skill taxonomy (resilience, leadership, AI literacy)

3 Document-by-Document Analysis

3.1 Master Student Employment Agreement (Career Center)

What it has. This document is the Career Center Student Employment Agreement. It sets expectations for student assistants, including:

- Time etiquette, absences, customer service, and professional conduct;
- Confidentiality and FERPA responsibilities;
- Dress code and modeling professionalism for other students;
- Timesheet accuracy and employment conditions;
- Mandatory monthly staff meetings/trainings;
- On-the-job and peer training;
- Mid-semester and end-of-semester check-ins;
- Progressive response to unmet expectations.

Importantly, it frames student employment as developmental: helping students prepare for post-college careers, not only complete office tasks.

How it can be used.

- Campus benchmark for comparing Career Center vs. FYE developmental systems;
- Shared language for professionalism, confidentiality, and performance management;
- Inspiration for mid/end check-in questions in supervisor or student interviews;
- Local-context evidence that Chico State already treats student jobs as career preparation.

Project connection. Supports the project's claim that campus student employment is already intended as career readiness practice. Useful when explaining why FYE assessment of reflection, feedback, and professionalism is aligned with broader campus norms.

Limitation. Career Center–specific (not FYE's exact protocol). Evaluation categories lean toward front-desk/customer-service roles.

3.2 Student Assistant Evaluation Sheet

What it has. An Excel supervisor evaluation form using a 1–4 scale:

> 1 = Unsatisfactory; 2 = Needs Improvement; 3 = Meets Expectations; 4 = Exceeds Expectations

Rated domains include:

- Professionalism (communication, confidentiality, attire, staff interaction);
- Customer Service (greeting, demeanor, patience, phone etiquette);
- Performance (accuracy, initiative, following directions, workflow proficiency);
- Work Habits (attendance, punctuality, productivity, shift handoff).

It also includes supervisor comments, dual signatures, and student reflective prompts such as:

- What do you like best about your job?
- What challenges you most?
- Are there skills you would like to use and/or develop?

How it can be used.

- Baseline instrument anatomy for FYE mid/end evaluation redesign;
- Keep the 1–4 scale while remapping items to FYE competencies;
- Mixed-methods design: quantitative ratings + open-ended skill-development prompts;
- Goal-setting link through the "skills to develop" question;
- Alumni adaptation ("skills used after graduation," "skills wished developed more").

Project connection. Directly supports assessment/feedback and guided goal-setting components. Provides a ready structure for comparing new vs. returning employees and for building more FYE-relevant rubrics.

Limitation. Tuned to Career Center/SEO workflow. Phone/employer items should be replaced with FYE-relevant behaviors (research support, peer coaching, facilitation, competency feedback quality).

3.3 Career Handbook (Chico State Career Center, Vol. 25)

What it has. A 26-page handbook covering job search, LinkedIn, AI use in career development, employer-sought skills, resumes/CVs, cover letters, career fair/elevator pitch, and interviewing. Highest-value content for this project includes:

- NACE Career Readiness Competencies: Communication, Critical Thinking, Teamwork, Professionalism, Equity & Inclusion, Technology, Career & Self-Development, Leadership;
- Skill-statement method: Power/Action Verb + Transferable Skill + Task/Result (basic $\rightarrow$ advanced $\rightarrow$ advanced with results);
- Interviewing guidelines and STAR method (Situation–Task–Action–Result);
- Sample behavioral questions and before/during/after interview checklists;
- AI prompts for interview practice and career action planning.

How it can be used.

- Local teaching framework to align FYE competencies with national career readiness language;
- Curriculum for interview-support workshops (huddles, UNIV 389, mid-semester PD);
- Weekly reflection scaffold (one STAR story per targeted competency);
- Coaching script for Training Leads giving competency feedback;
- Alumni survey constructs (which skills mattered most after graduation).

Project connection. This is the strongest practical toolkit for the project's interview-support and evidence-based skill-story goals. It also supplies the NACE competency language used in the project's alignment slides and recommendations.

Limitation. General career education resource; not FYE outcome data. Use as intervention content and framework, not as proof of FYE impact.

3.4 NACE Job Outlook 2026 Spring Update

What it has. A National Association of Colleges and Employers (NACE) survey update (fielded February 12–March 17, 2026; roughly 185 employer respondents) on Class of 2026 hiring, AI, and skills/attributes employers seek. Key findings include:

- Employers project about a 5.6% hiring increase for the Class of 2026;

- High-priority resume attributes include teamwork, communication, problem-solving, initiative, analytical skills, adaptability, leadership potential, detail orientation, and technical/computer skills;
- Employers strongly prefer candidates who demonstrate skills **with examples**, not merely list them;
- AI skill demand is rising for entry-level work (tool selection, prompting, productivity use, reviewing AI outputs).

How it can be used.

- Rationale for why weekly reflection must produce evidence-based narratives;
- Benchmark FYE-emphasized skills against national employer priorities;
- Justify interview/STAR practice as career readiness, not optional soft training;
- Support an optional AI/tech literacy recommendation for FYE;
- Inform alumni questions about whether graduates can show FYE-based examples in hiring.

Project connection. Validates the project's core improvement area: students already do meaningful FYE work; they need practice proving those skills. This source strengthens literature/rationale sections and recommendation briefs for supervisors/admins.

Limitation. National sample, not Chico State–specific. Verify exact chart percentages when citing formally.

3.5 WEF Future of Jobs Report 2025

What it has. World Economic Forum insight report (January 2025) based on 1,000+ employers across industries and economies, projecting 2025–2030 skill and job change. Core skills emphasized include analytical thinking; resilience/flexibility/agility; leadership and social influence; creative thinking; motivation and self-awareness; technological literacy; empathy and active listening; curiosity and lifelong learning. Fastest-growing skills include AI and big data, cybersecurity, technological literacy, creative thinking, resilience, lifelong learning, and leadership. The report also highlights large-scale upskilling needs and skill gaps as a major transformation barrier.

How it can be used.

- Future-proof FYE competency language (resilience, lifelong learning, leadership, tech/AI);
- Justify weekly reflection as lifelong-learning practice, not only semester compliance;
- Frame Training Lead mentoring as early talent-management / leadership practice;
- Support discussion sections that place FYE in global upskilling discourse;
- Inform alumni constructs about preparedness for skill change.

Project connection. Provides the long-horizon skill taxonomy that complements NACE's nearer-term employer view. Strengthens the argument that FYE should build durable human skills plus emerging tech literacy.

Limitation. Global/macro source. Use for foresight and framing, not as local outcome evidence.

4 How the Documents Work Together

External demand	Local practice	Project use
WEF future skills	Employment Agreement check-ins	Define which skills matter
NACE Job Outlook	Evaluation Sheet rubrics	Design/adapt assessment language
Career Handbook (NACE 8 + STAR)	FYE weekly process (mapped in slides)	Build interview + reflection supports

Practical synthesis:

- Use **WEF + NACE + Career Handbook** to define which competencies matter and how to evidence them;
- Use **Employment Agreement + Evaluation Sheet** to benchmark campus practice and adapt instruments;
- Combine all five research references for process mapping, skill alignment, gap analysis, and recommendations.

5 Connection to Each Project Component

Project component	Best reference supports	Immediate use
Weekly reflection	Handbook skill statements; WEF lifelong learning; NACE examples finding	STAR/example-based Self-Report prompts
Assessment & feedback	Evaluation Sheet; Employment Agreement check-ins; NACE evidence standard	Mid/end rubric adaptation
Goal-setting	Evaluation “skills to develop” prompt; Handbook career action planning	1:1 goal worksheet language
Interview support	Handbook STAR section; NACE examples preference	Interview practice recommendations
Multi-cohort inquiry	All frameworks + Evaluation Sheet prompts	New/returning/alumni question banks
Program improvement	Combined gap analysis across all sources	Recommendations brief for FYE

6 What Is Strong vs. Still Missing

6.1 Already strong in the research references

- Clear national/global skill frameworks (NACE, WEF);
- Campus career-readiness teaching tools (handbook);
- Local evaluation and professionalism templates;
- Enough material to support skill alignment, gap analysis, and recommendations.

6.2 Important gaps still needed for full empirical assessment

- Official FYE competency list/rubric used in Work Package;
- Blank/sample Work Package pages (Practice Plan, Self-Report, feedback);
- Mid-semester evaluation and rehire/exit interview protocols;
- UNIV 389 syllabus and reflection assignments;
- De-identified artifact samples and/or survey responses;
- Alumni contact/consent process details.

These missing pieces are what turn the current folder from a framework library into a complete evidence dataset.

7 Recommended Uses Going Forward

1. Keep using the references to justify recommendations (especially STAR practice, evidence-based stories, light AI/tech readiness).
2. Cite NACE/WEF in supervisor briefs and final report rationale sections.
3. Adapt Evaluation Sheet structure when FYE instruments are finalized.
4. Use Career Handbook language in any interview-support recommendation or pilot.
5. Request the missing FYE artifacts listed above to move from document analysis to outcome assessment.

8 Conclusion

The research references already provide a strong foundation for the FYE career-readiness project. Local documents show how student employment and evaluation are organized on campus; external documents show what employers and future labor markets value. Connected to the project, these five sources support process mapping, skill alignment, gap analysis, and recommendations—and they prepare the ground for later instrument design and multi-cohort data collection once FYE-specific Work Package materials are available.

9 Source Files Reviewed

- `references/Master Student Employment Agreement.docx`
- `references/Student Assistant Evaluation Sheet.xlsx`
- `references/career-handbook-2.pdf`
- `references/2026-job-outlook-report-spring-update.pdf`
- `references/WEF_Future_of_Jobs_Report_2025.pdf`

Excluded from research references (project-update files only):
`F26_ REC Project Proposal [Pushpak].pdf`;
`Document_Utility_Summary_FYE_Career_Readiness_Study.md`.

Note: This report synthesizes currently available reference materials for project planning and supervisor communication. Formal citations in the final academic report should quote exact figures from the original PDFs.